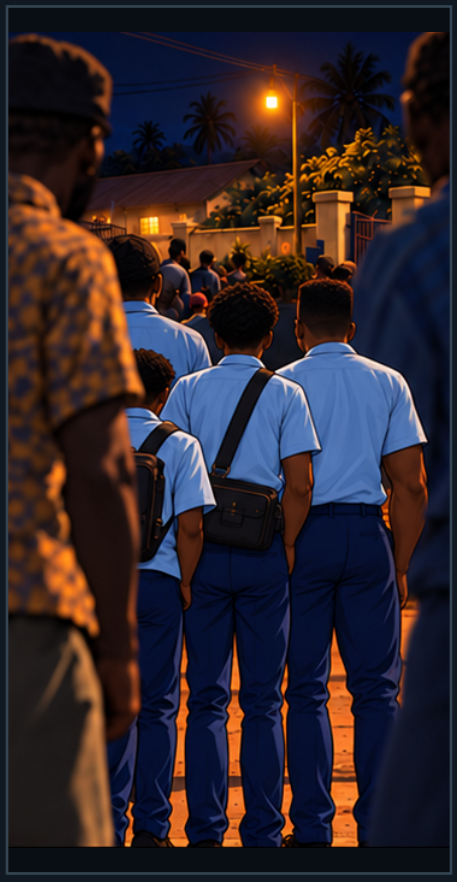
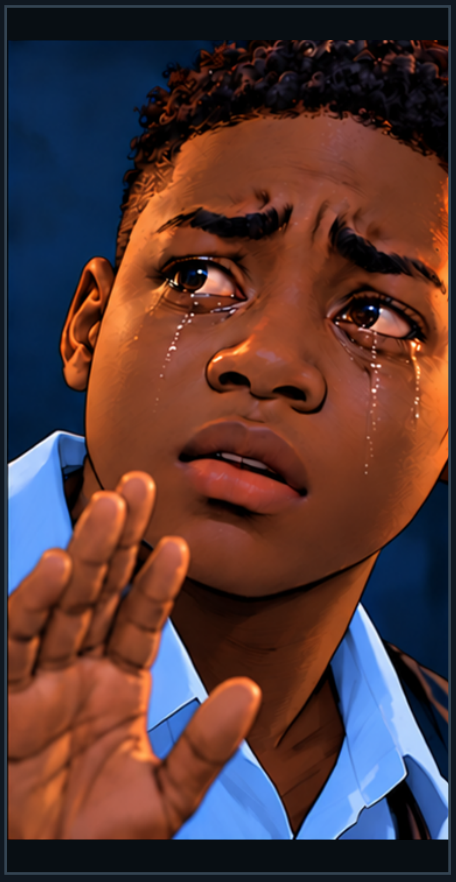
THE MAN WHO NEVER RAN

A boy invents a man who never runs. When a real crowd turns violent, he must choose between the hero he performs and the friends he can actually protect.







CHAPTER ONE / FIANGO / CINEMATIC STORYBOARD

A real visual sequence: eighteen distinct illustrated moments, a camera and sound plan, and an independent critic review.

30 October 2026 · Author-based dramatic composite · English / Cameroon Pidgin

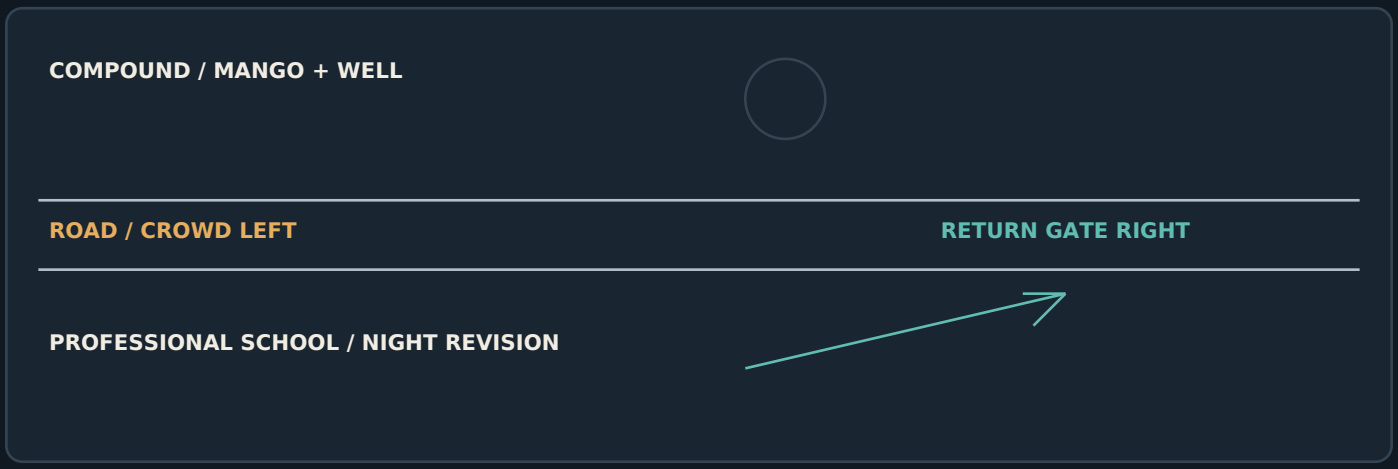
THE THRILLER ENGINE

Who is he when his story cannot save anyone?

OPEN: an older Zino cannot answer Mother. RETURN: meet him at ten inventing Grand. ESCALATE: later night revision becomes a witness event. CHOOSE: take both friends out. PAY OFF: the storyteller begins an account he cannot rewrite.

I / 0:00–1:34	A rule: Grand never runs.
II / 1:34–3:24	A crowd makes the rule impossible.
III / 3:24–5:00	Zino chooses people over a performance.

SPATIAL CONTRACT / SCREEN DIRECTIONS



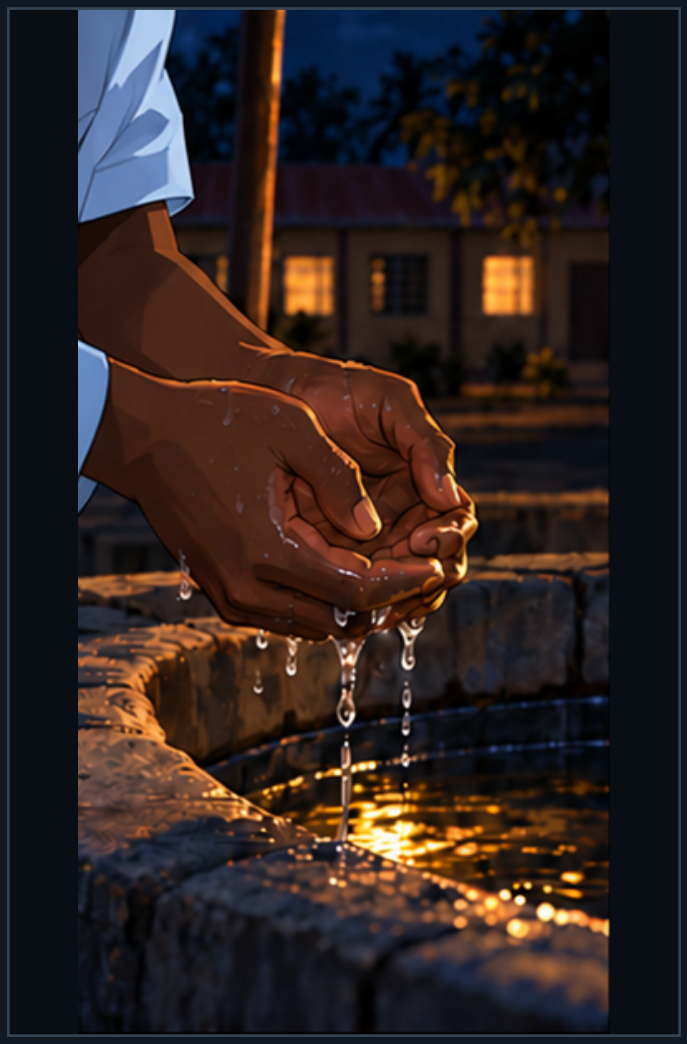
The wide gate shot comes before obstruction. Return stays toward the already shown gate; no chase, surprise exit or invented perpetrator. Lens numbers describe equivalent framing for animation.

SOURCE AND EDIT LIMITS

Age fourteen / approximately 2004 is a proposed composite placement of secondary-school witness memories. Dialogue, individual actions and camera blocking are dramatized. The cards explicitly show the age-ten passage. These are eighteen keyframes, not thirty-six finished drawings or an animated film.

K01 / 0:00–0:12 / SHOTS 01–02

The question



ECU → close / 85 mm feel / locked

Fresh drinking water from a drawn bucket leaks from fourteen-year-old Zino's cupped hands. He cannot lift it steadily to his mouth. Mother asks what happened.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

Water, breath. Mother's English: ‘What happened?’ No score.

CUT / WHY THIS SHOT

The water-drop sound becomes a football thump. What has robbed him of his voice? Establish the bucket beside the well in the wider layout; no washing into the water supply.

K02 / 0:12–0:23 / SHOTS 03–04

Four years earlier



Ground-level wide / 28 mm feel

Ten-year-old Zino sends a scuffed ball at a goal made from two slippers. The ball skims the outside post.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

Feet, dust, ball. Card: FOUR YEARS EARLIER.

CUT / WHY THIS SHOT

Follow the failed shot into the friendship argument. Meet the boy in motion, before trauma defines him.

K03 / 0:23–0:39 / SHOTS 05–06

The boy who can talk



Medium triangle / 35 mm feel / rising hand

Seated Gideon, W hairline and almost-afro, calls the miss. High-flat-top Luc pauses a conversation. Neither plays. Both retain age-ten bodies. Zino raises a finger: defeat becomes an audience.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

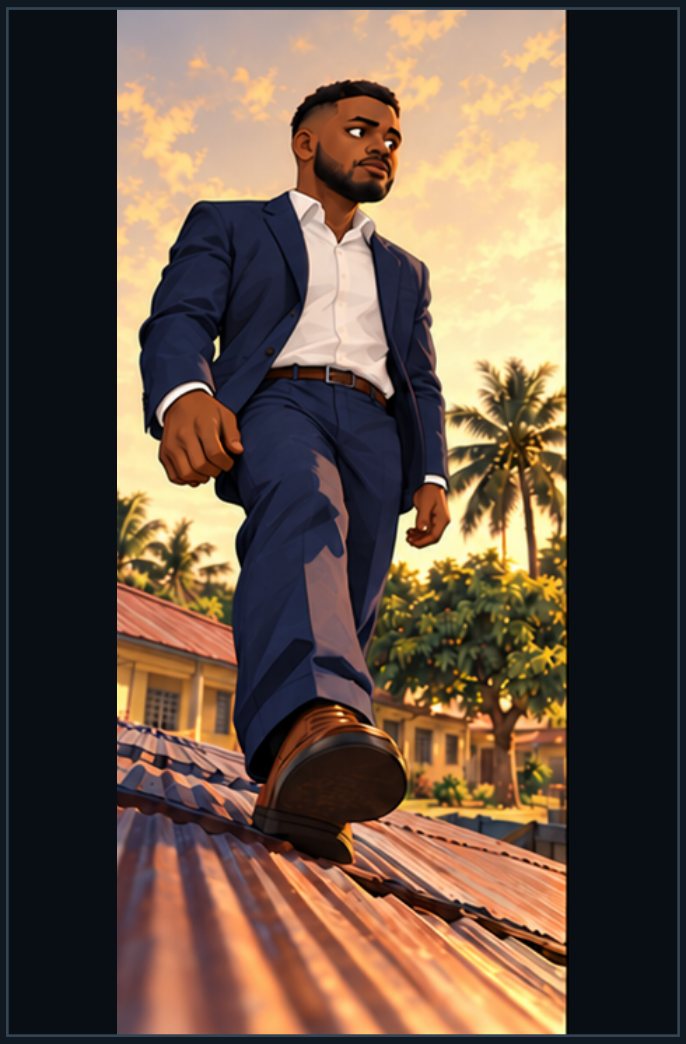
Gideon: ‘Outside.’ Zino: ‘Grand-Chukuchuku score from worse side.’

CUT / WHY THIS SHOT

Match Zino's raised hand to his invented adult ideal. Charisma is an action. Ayuk and the other street peers play; the two friends have separate lives beside the pitch.

K04 / 0:39–0:50 / SHOTS 07–08

The man who never ran



Low angle / 28 mm feel / composed silhouette

In Zino's active tale, Grand walks the same roofline in navy and gold. A real-world interruption ends the fantasy immediately.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

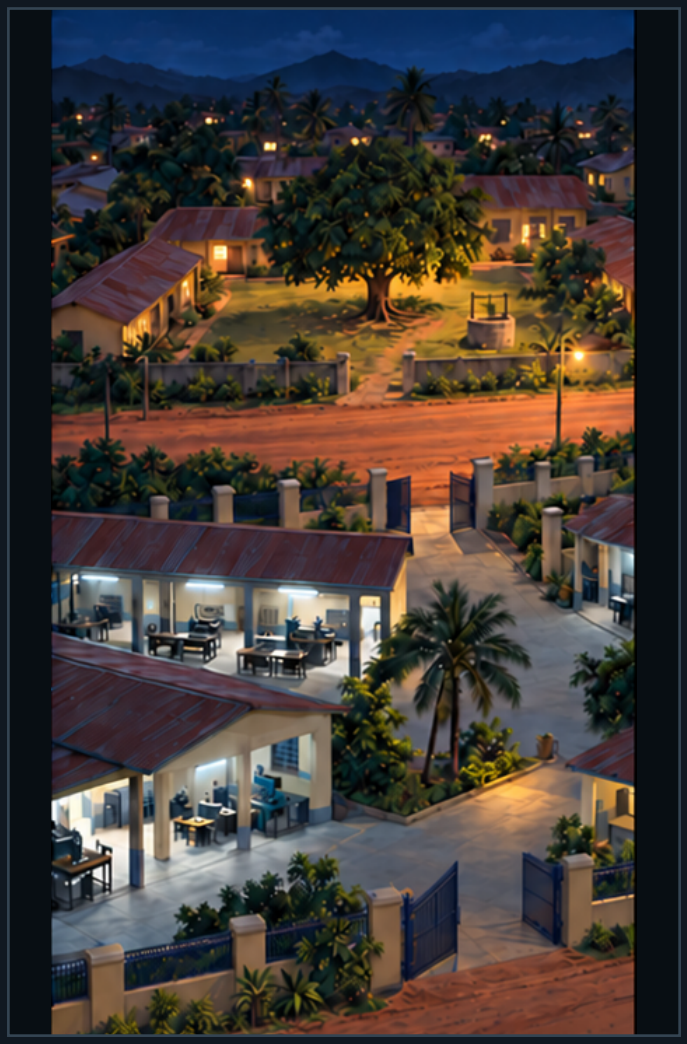
Zino: ‘Grand-Chukuchuku no ever run.’ Mother O.S.: ‘Zino. The water.’

CUT / WHY THIS SHOT

Gold disappears on Mother's call. One clear second time card. Plant a heroic rule that reality will test; Grand never enters the real crowd.

K05 / 0:50–1:05 / SHOTS 09–10

Before the shout



High wide / 24 mm feel / geographical master

FOUR YEARS LATER — EARLIER THAT EVENING. Professional School works as a real night revision space; its gate, road and the compound opposite are readable.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

Pencils, low conversation, electrical hum. No ominous trailer hit.

CUT / WHY THIS SHOT

Move from architecture into the boys' shared exercise book. Re-enter the opening's older timeline and establish the route before danger.

K06 / 1:05–1:34 / SHOTS 11–13

Three different futures



Over-table diagonal / 35 mm feel

Zino returns the pencil to Luc: high flat-top, trained teenage shoulders, small Bible. Gideon, W hairline and almost-afro, shields his camera bag and thinks about his next paying job.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

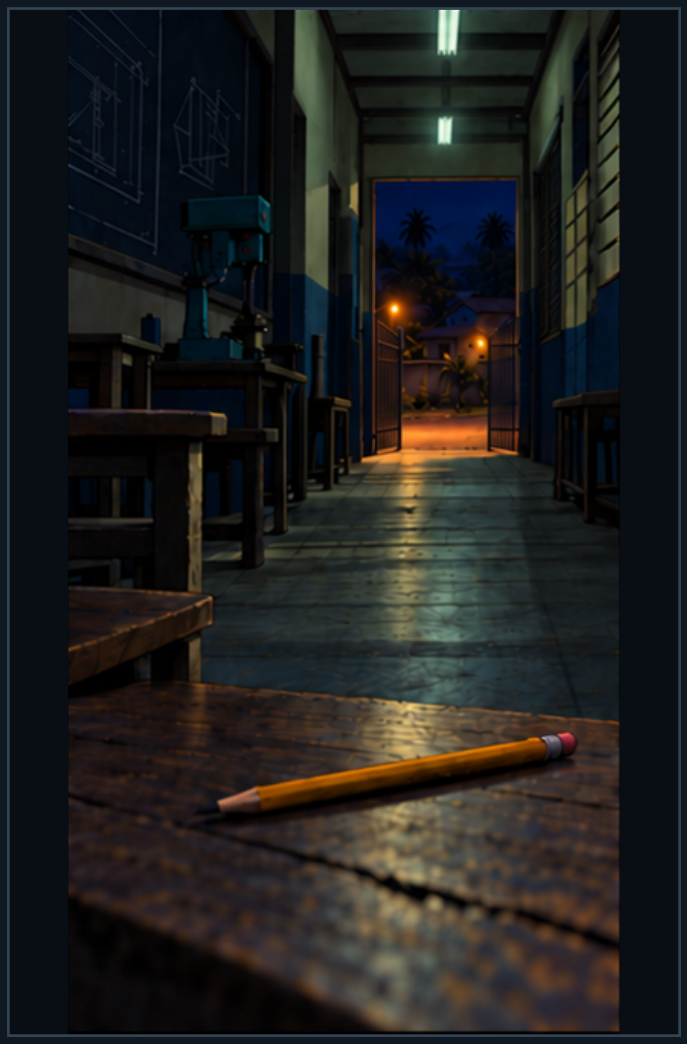
Zino: ‘You solve am. I only show you road.’ Gideon: ‘You people finish, find me one customer.’

CUT / WHY THIS SHOT

The conversation continues into an empty corridor shot. Ability, faith, work and humour exist before the threat.

K07 / 1:34–1:42 / SHOTS 14

A word outside



Long corridor / 65 mm feel / negative space

The frame is mostly empty vocational-school architecture. From beyond the gate comes an accusation, before any visible cause.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

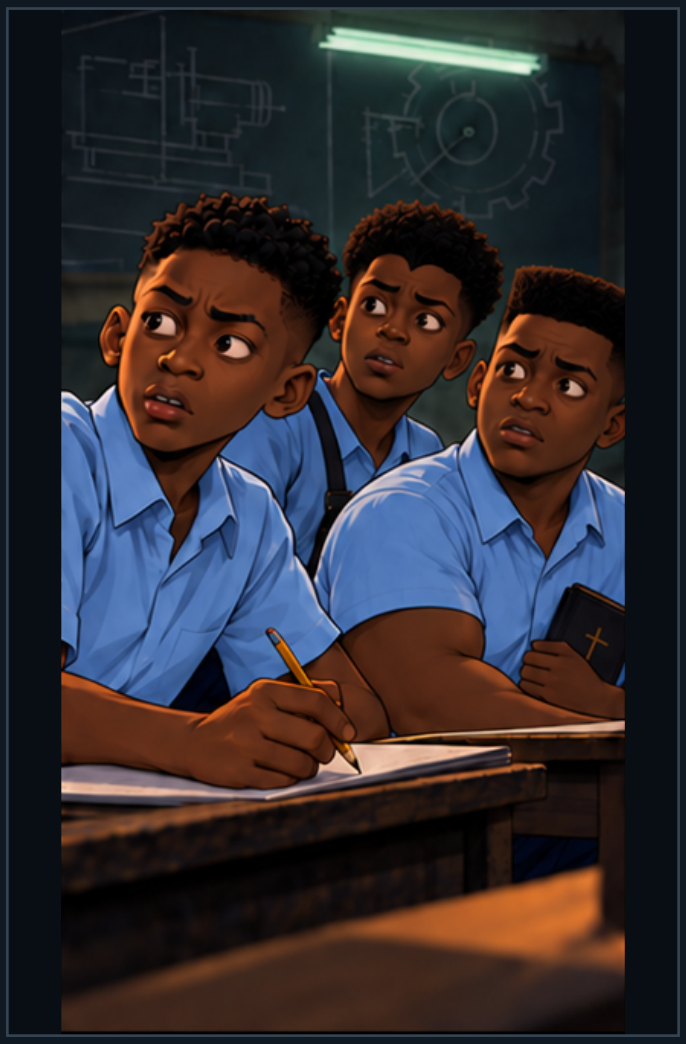
O.S.: ‘Thief!’ The pencil rhythm stops. No image validates the word.

CUT / WHY THIS SHOT

Sound leads to the three boys looking up. The audience knows no more than the witnesses. Attention becomes danger.

K08 / 1:42–1:56 / SHOTS 15–16

Curiosity moves first



Three-quarter close group / 50 mm feel

Zino turns first; Gideon measures the movement outside; Luc hesitates. They follow students toward the familiar gate.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

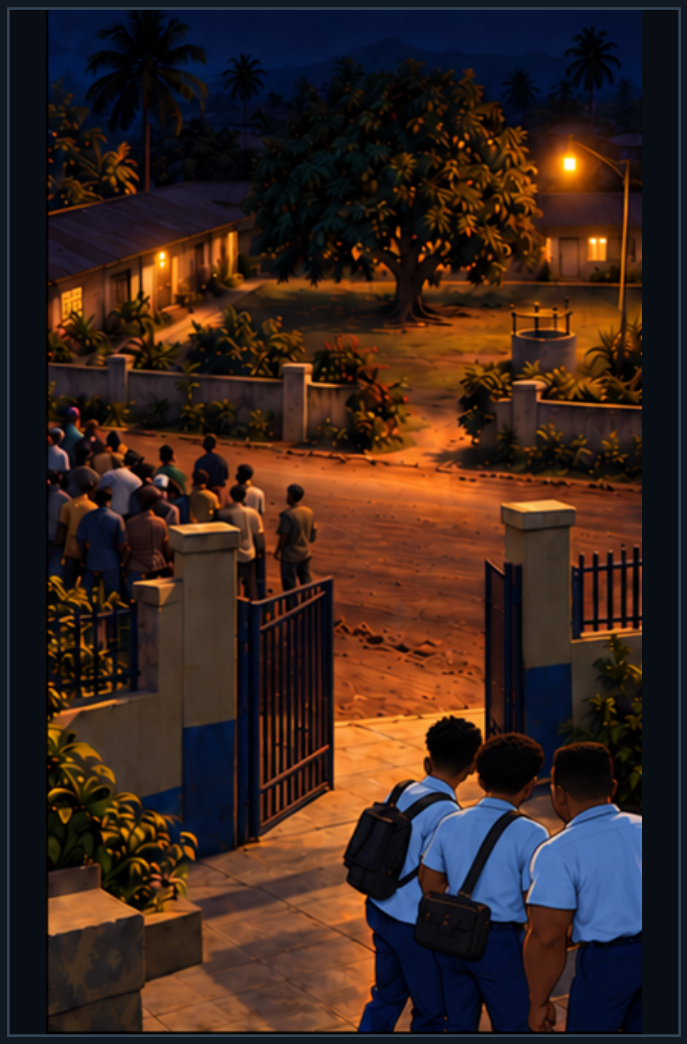
Chair scrape. Luc: ‘Make we leave am.’ Zino does not answer.

CUT / WHY THIS SHOT

A motivated track ends on a clear gate-wide composition. Their different instincts create the forward movement.

K09 / 1:56–2:20 / SHOTS 17–19

The last clear view



Wide from school side / 28 mm feel

The crowd gathers left of frame in the road. The lit school gate remains behind/right. The three boys stop at the edge, not inside the circle.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

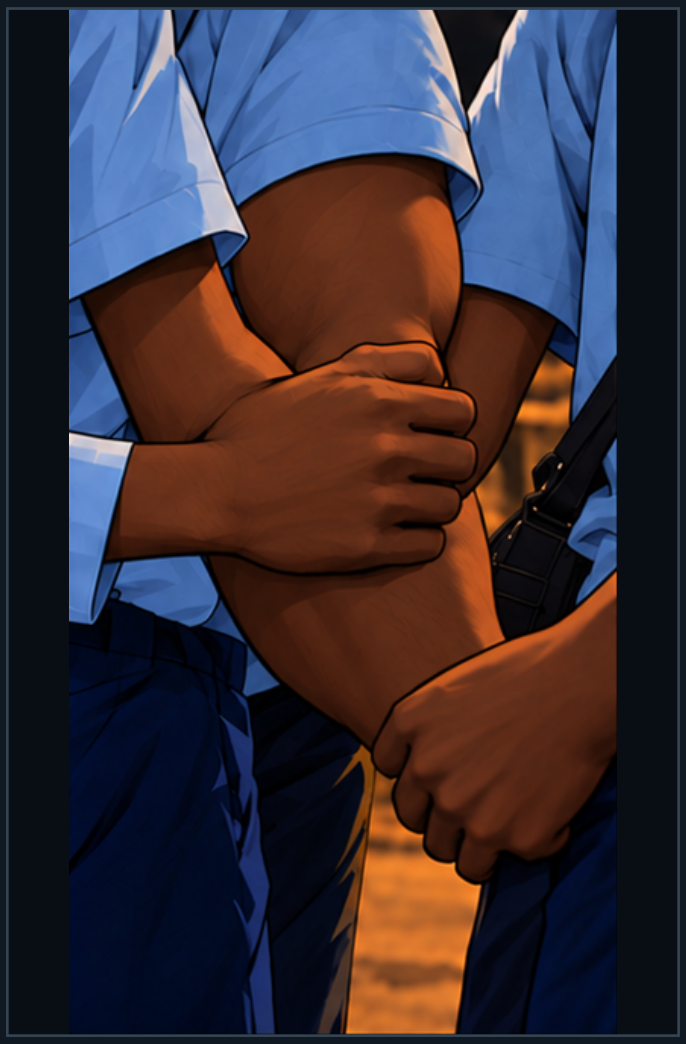
Several overlapping voices; no authoritative accuser or explanation.

CUT / WHY THIS SHOT

Hold the open return route before adults cross the foreground. Establish where they are and how they can leave.

K10 / 2:20–2:29 / SHOTS 20

Keep hold



Hand insert / 85 mm feel

Zino grips Luc's sky-blue sleeve as people pass between them. Gideon's camera bag remains visible. All three wear sky-blue shirts and dark-blue trousers; faces and props distinguish them.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

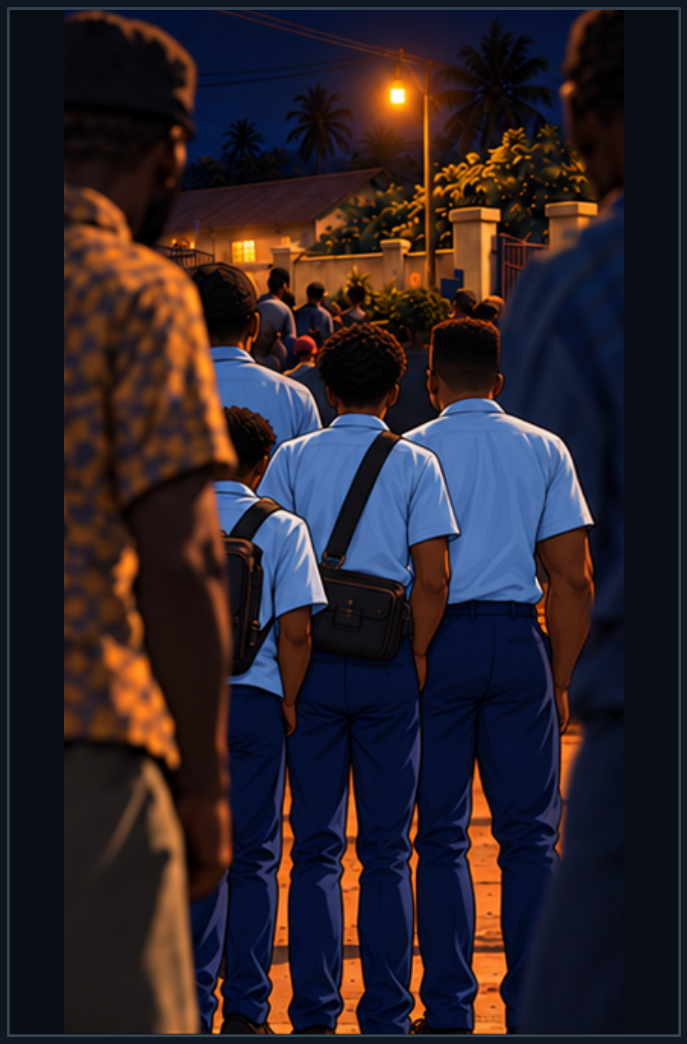
Cloth, breathing, crowd close. Zino: ‘Stay here.’

CUT / WHY THIS SHOT

Hands connect the boys before the crowd fills the frame. Zino's protective instinct begins before the final decision.

K11 / 2:29–2:46 / SHOTS 21–22

The street closes



Compressed witness height / 85 mm feel

Adult shoulders layer across the boys. Gideon keeps his bag closed. There is still a way back; nobody is pursuing them.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

The crowd drowns individual voices. No action score.

CUT / WHY THIS SHOT

A moving elbow opens a brief sightline to the person inside. Fear comes from scale and restricted information, not a fabricated chase.

K12 / 2:46–3:05 / SHOTS 23–24

A man, not an accusation



Obstructed POV / level horizon / 65 mm feel

Through a gap, an anonymous adult is restrained on the road. His raised hand is a human plea. Zino starts a word and stops.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

A struck body, a voice pleading, the boys' breath. No narration calls him guilty.

CUT / WHY THIS SHOT

Stay on the witnesses' side of the line as violence escalates. Reveal actual harm; the moral stakes replace childhood bravado.

K13 / 3:05–3:24 / SHOTS 25–26

The rupture



Witness POV / no overhead spectacle

The crowd's brutality becomes fire around the restrained adult. Foreground bodies obstruct his identity. The boys receive heat and sound; this is no bonfire celebration.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

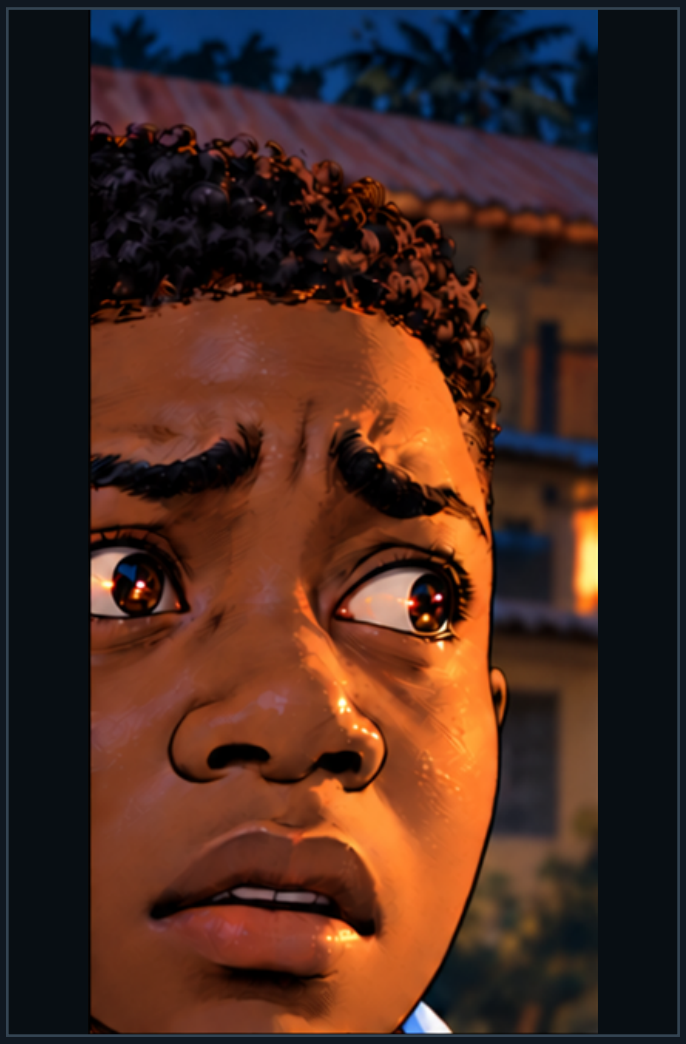
Scream, ignition, breath; score absent. End on a reaction, not a musical accent.

CUT / WHY THIS SHOT

Cut from actual harm to the ordinary roofline Zino once gave to Grand. The witness event is real to the characters. Its guilt, names and exact historical date remain unknown.

K14 / 3:24–3:42 / SHOTS 27–28

The story will not come



Tight reaction / 85 mm feel / roof insert pending

Zino looks for the answer he used to invent. This frame draws his reaction; the separate empty-roof insert in shot 27 still needs a layout drawing. Grand does not arrive.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

No gold chime. The crowd remains at real distance. Luc tries to speak.

CUT / WHY THIS SHOT

Planned empty-roof insert, then this face; attention returns to both living friends. Pay off the fantasy through absence. Do not claim the missing roof-angle coverage is drawn here.

K15 / 3:42–4:13 / SHOTS 29–31

Two people he can help



Lateral medium → gate wide / 35 mm feel

Zino takes Luc and Gideon together toward the established gate, then home. All three remain accounted for. Leaving is not a chase or victory.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

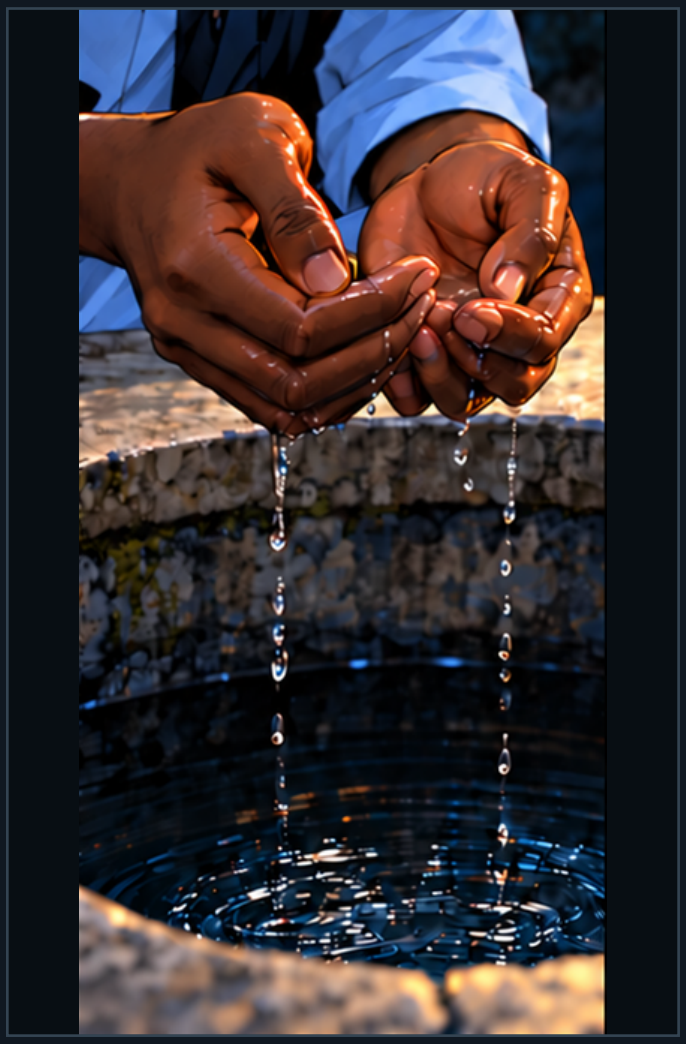
Zino: ‘Luc. Gideon. We go.’ Footsteps replace the roar gradually.

CUT / WHY THIS SHOT

School light shrinks; cut to the familiar well, now emotionally changed. A consequential choice: give up performing invulnerability to care for the people beside him.

K16 / 4:13–4:36 / SHOTS 32–33

The opening, understood



Compound master → opening hand position

At home, Zino tries to drink fresh water lifted from the drawn bucket beside the well. His trembling cupped hands match the cold open. He is not washing into the well.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

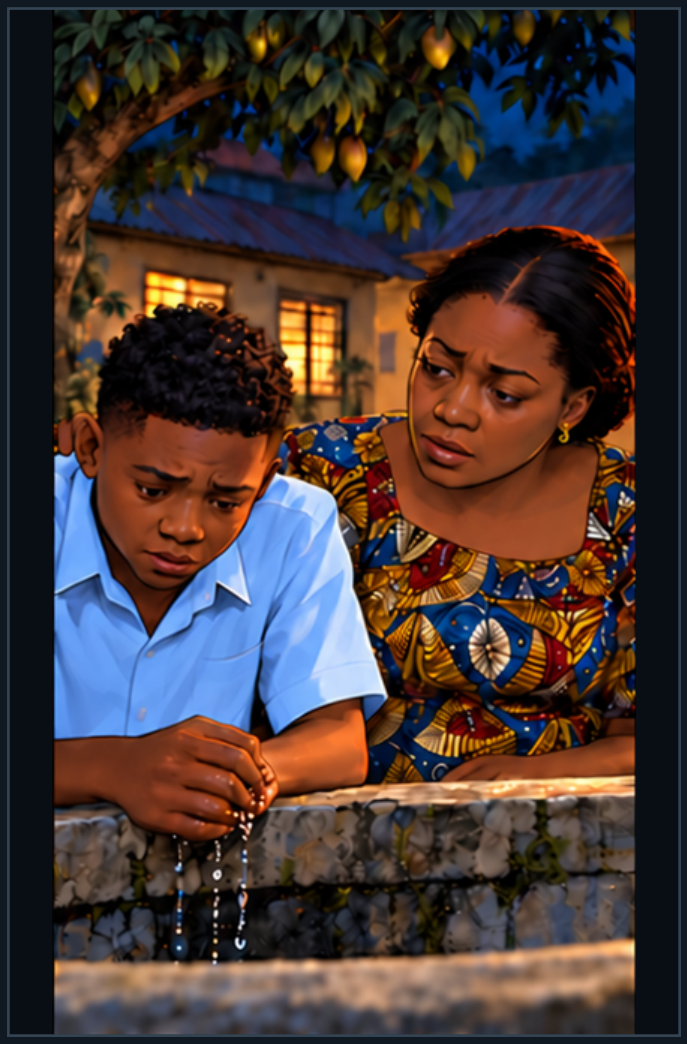
Well rope, bucket, insects. No explanatory voice-over.

CUT / WHY THIS SHOT

Mother sets down her exercise books and joins him. Close the opening mystery through witnessed cause. Clarify bucket position in the wider animation layout.

K17 / 4:36–4:44 / SHOTS 34

No performance required



Still eye-level two-shot / 50 mm feel

Mother stays beside him at the well. She asks one question in English; he tries the familiar smile and cannot hold it.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

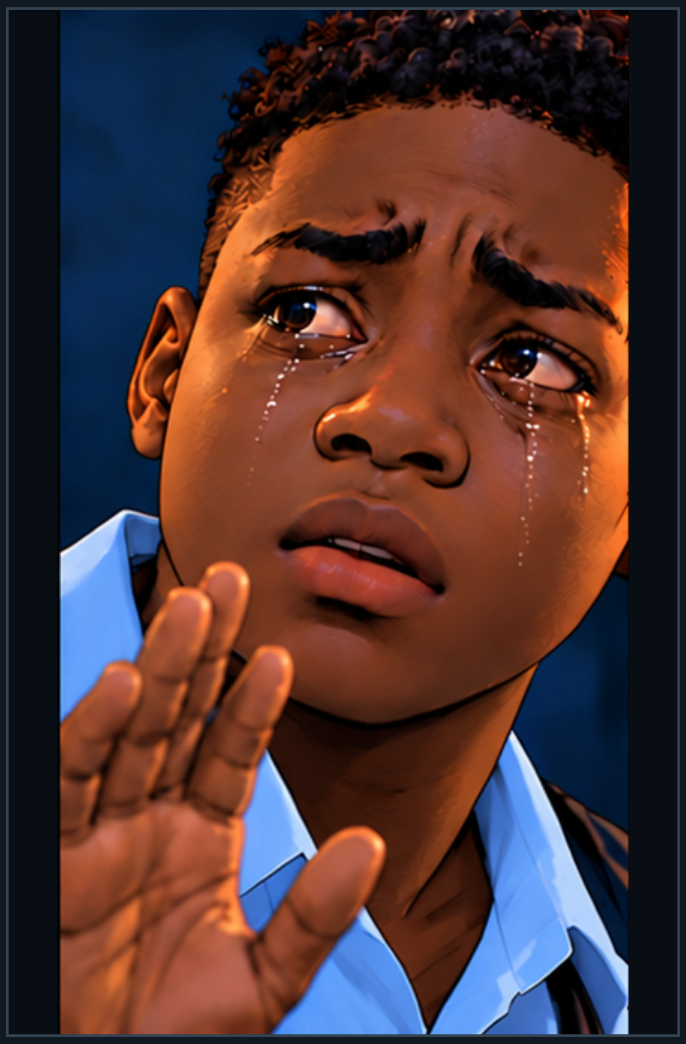
Mother: ‘What happened?’ Hold after the question.

CUT / WHY THIS SHOT

Make the final close-up an earned change in intimacy. Care gives Zino a place where he can stop being entertaining.

K18 / 4:44–5:00 / SHOTS 35–36

The first true sentence



Tight three-quarter / 85 mm feel / almost still

His storytelling hand lifts, then falls. ‘Grand…’ cannot become a rescue story. He meets Mother’s eyeline: ‘There was a man.’ Hold, then black.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

English at home. Breath and water; title receives one unresolved note after black.

CUT / WHY THIS SHOT

Title only in final two seconds. The next episode must continue the confession. End on changed behaviour and a costly truth, not an unrelated knock or withheld fee amount.

Every cut has a reason

Eighteen illustrated keyframes support this thirty-six-shot target edit. Intermediate movement, inserts and reverse coverage still need animation layout and an animatic.

# / FRAME	TIME / CAMERA	ACTION
01 / K01	0:00–0:06 ECU / locked	Fresh drinking water leaks from shaking cupped hands; drawn bucket beside well.
02 / K01	0:06–0:12 Close / Mother O.S.	‘What happened?’ He cannot answer. No physical attacker at home.
03 / K02	0:12–0:15 Time card / audio match	FOUR YEARS EARLIER. Water becomes football sound.
04 / K02	0:15–0:23 Ground wide	The ball brushes the outside slipper. Clear miss, no money game.
05 / K03	0:23–0:30 Medium triangle / sidelines	Gideon, W hairline/almost-afro, banters from his seat; flat-top Luc pauses a conversation; neither plays. Both have age-ten child proportions.
06 / K03	0:30–0:39 Hand-led tilt	Zino begins his impossible Grand tale. Fantasy is actively triggered.
07 / K04	0:39–0:47 Low fantasy wide	Adult Grand walks the familiar roofline, entirely inside the told story.
08 / K04	0:47–0:50 Return to boy / audio cut	‘Grand-Chukuchuku no ever run.’ Mother: ‘Zino. The water.’
09 / K05	0:50–0:56 Time card / high master	FOUR YEARS LATER — EARLIER THAT EVENING. School foreground, road, compound.
10 / K05	0:56–1:05 Interior establishing wide	Practical wiring/building diagrams, workbenches and real night readers.
11 / K06	1:05–1:16 Over-table diagonal	Zino shows a maths step, then returns the pencil to flat-top Luc, whose trained older-secondary build stays age-appropriate.
12 / K06	1:16–1:25 Same desk / Gideon emphasis	Gideon shields the closed camera bag from an elbow and jokes about customers.
13 / K06	1:25–1:34 Same desk / Luc emphasis	Luc welcomes a willing listener briefly; the pencil returns him to work.
14 / K07	1:34–1:42 Empty corridor / locked	An offscreen accusation interrupts study. No theft is shown.
15 / K08	1:42–1:49 Close three-quarter group	Each friend looks up differently: curiosity, calculation, caution.
16 / K08	1:49–1:56 Motivated corridor follow	They follow other students toward the known gate.
17 / K09	1:56–2:04 Gate master	Crowd screen-left; lit return gate behind/right; boys at the edge.
18 / K09	2:04–2:12 Hold / foreground crossings	Conflicting voices deny certainty. No authoritative villain portrait.

Every cut has a reason

Eighteen illustrated keyframes support this thirty-six-shot target edit. Intermediate movement, inserts and reverse coverage still need animation layout and an animatic.

# / FRAME	TIME / CAMERA	ACTION
19 / K09	2:12–2:20 Same frame / Luc hesitates	Luc stops; the other two register him before moving any further.
20 / K10	2:20–2:29 Sleeve insert	Zino holds Luc near; Gideon's camera bag remains in sight. All three wear sky-blue/navy.
21 / K11	2:29–2:39 Compressed child-height wide	Adult shoulders obscure the boys and road. Exit still exists.
22 / K11	2:39–2:46 Hold / closed bag detail	Gideon keeps the camera in its bag; no evidence photograph is invented.
23 / K12	2:46–2:55 Obstructed witness POV	A restrained adult raises a pleading hand; no finding of guilt.
24 / K12	2:55–3:05 Reaction within same sightline	Zino begins a word and cannot make it work.
25 / K13	3:05–3:15 Witness POV / direct harm	Tires and restraint register as the crowd's violence escalates.
26 / K13	3:15–3:24 Hold / fire changes light	The attack becomes fire. Scream and physical consequence, no triumphant score.
27 / K14	3:24–3:33 PLANNED / empty-roof insert	Undrawn coverage: the imagined hero's space is empty. K14 depicts the reaction.
28 / K14	3:33–3:42 Zino near / friends held	He looks between Luc and Gideon; he knows where both are.
29 / K15	3:42–3:52 Lateral three-shot	Zino takes both friends toward the established right-side gate.
30 / K15	3:52–4:02 Gate-wide extension	All three pass into the clear route. Nobody pursues them.
31 / K15	4:02–4:13 Held return movement	Their footsteps take over from the crowd; school light recedes.
32 / K16	4:13–4:24 Compound master	Mango, well and occupied homes return as stable landmarks.
33 / K16	4:24–4:36 Exact opening hand position	He cannot steady fresh drinking water to his mouth. No washing into well or invented injury.
34 / K17	4:36–4:44 Still mother/son two-shot	Mother sets her work aside. ‘What happened?’ English at home.
35 / K18	4:44–4:54 Tight / no fantasy	‘Grand…’ fails. ‘There was a man.’ His hand stops performing.
36 / K18	4:54–5:00 Held face → black	Let the truthful beginning land. Final two seconds: title.

QUALITY GATES

Approval must follow the actual work.

01 / THRILLER CAUSALITY

The opening question is answered by a witnessed cause. Zino makes a consequential choice rather than waiting for Mother to reveal a bill.

02 / DRAWN SHOTS

Eighteen unique frames show specific actions, shot sizes and viewpoints. Intermediate layout work is listed rather than claimed finished.

03 / CONTINUITY

Clear age/time cards; English at home; no age-ten primary-fee confusion; Gideon’s camera stays out of the early passage and closed later.

04 / CONSEQUENCE

The adult’s guilt is unknown. No invented evidence, pursuit, rescue or new antagonist. Ordinary friendship and competence precede harm.

05 / INDEPENDENT VERDICT

Read CRITIC_FINAL_REVIEW.md for the critic’s final findings on the script and actual sheet images. Remaining limitations belong in the handoff.

NEXT PRODUCTION PASS

Record the dialogue; draw missing coverage and acting poses; lock the teenage model/wardrobe; verify the witness-event date with the author; then assemble and time a five-minute animatic. No score may turn the violence into triumph. The rejected v1 Artlist music plan does not govern this cut.

CREDITS / PROVENANCE

Story foundations: Nkeh Nkengzincho. Writing, camera and independent critic work are retained in this directory. Visuals: three newly generated storyboard sheets using the author-supplied compound and Grand model references. Source generations and unused first attempts remain preserved. No award or studio affiliation is implied.